THE BAZAAR OF LIES

THE ARENA RECORD



In the Matter of

The Parity Verdict of Shuttered Stalls

The Judgment of the Council of Elders

Match 1 — Cycles 1–5, Year of the Ledger's Echo

Abstract:
Across five cycles, the bazaar scrutinized ten merchants through village votes and Family shutterings. The Detective (Elsa) was shuttered first; subsequent banishments removed the Doctor (Ripley), two Mafia (Sherlock, Hermione), and two Villagers (Morpheus, Gandalf, Neo, Inigo). The match concluded with parity: one Family member (Yoda) and one Villager (Batman) remaining. The Family secured victory by stall shuttering.



The bazaar rests.

Match 1 — Cycles 1–5, Year of the Ledger's Echo

The Council of Elders convenes beneath the bazaar's iron-bound lanterns, the match's ledger unsealed before us. Ten merchants entered; five stalls shuttered; one village vote echoed louder than the rest. The Family's candlelight council whispered in shadows, their shutter falling on six merchants before the village's tally could close the final gap. We weigh each thread—every vote, every silence, every receipt left unsigned—and render judgment not in blood, but in ink.

The History

- **Cycle 1**:
  - Vote tally: Sherlock (10) = 3, Morpheus (8) = 3, Ripley (5) = 3, Elsa (7) = 1
  - Night action: Elsa (7) (Detective) targeted Inigo (9); Ripley (5) (Doctor) targeted Morpheus (8); Sherlock (10) (Mafia) targeted Elsa (7); Yoda (3) (Mafia) targeted Gandalf (1); Hermione (2) (Mafia) targeted Batman (4); Detective investigated Inigo (9) — finding: not Family; Family's council talked (3 messages)
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Elsa (7) — true role Detective
- **Cycle 2**:
  - Vote tally: Ripley (5) = 8, Morpheus (8) = 1
  - Night action: Hermione (2) (Mafia) targeted Morpheus (8); Yoda (3) (Mafia) targeted Morpheus (8); Sherlock (10) (Mafia) targeted Morpheus (8); Family's council talked (4 messages), declaring Morpheus (8)
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Morpheus (8) — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Ripley (5) — true role Doctor
- **Cycle 3**:
  - Vote tally: Sherlock (10) = 6, Gandalf (1) = 1
  - Night action: Yoda (3) (Mafia) targeted Inigo (9); Hermione (2) (Mafia) targeted Inigo (9); Family's council talked (10 messages), declaring Inigo (9)
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Inigo (9) — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Sherlock (10) — true role Mafia
- **Cycle 4**:
  - Vote tally: Hermione (2) = 2, Neo (6) = 1, Gandalf (1) = 1, Batman (4) = 1
  - Night action: Yoda (3) (Mafia) targeted Neo (6); Family's council talked (0 messages)
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Neo (6) — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Hermione (2) — true role Mafia
- **Cycle 5**:
  - Vote tally: Gandalf (1) = 3
  - Night action: none
  - Departures: the village BANISHED them by day vote: Gandalf (1) — true role Villager

- **Conclusion**: THE FAMILY WINS — 1 Family member(s) against 1 honest merchant(s) as the match ended; the win condition is parity or better.

The Main Arguments

The Ledger's Authority

The bazaar's iron-clad rule—*"receipts, not echoes"*—dominated discourse. **Ripley (05)** framed silence as debt: *"The ledger does not trade in echoes—it trades in receipts, and receipts bear fingerprints."* (Cycle 1, #8). **Batman (04)** reinforced this, rejecting metaphors: *"Seat-04 Batman does not weave. Seat-04 Batman does not trade in drafts."* (Cycle 1, #7). The Family exploited this, with **Hermione (02)** weaponizing the ledger's absence: *"Your whetstone hums a dry tune while your tally page yawns empty."* (Cycle 1, #9). The village's votes followed the scent of copper where others offered perfume.

The Blank Page's Paradox

The central tension: merchants who demanded receipts while their own ledgers remained blank. **Gandalf (01)** excoriated others' absences but refused to produce his own tally, culminating in his banishment: *"No entry, no debt."* (Cycle 1, #2). **Morpheus (08)** pressed Sherlock (10) for answers: *"Did you vote with Hermione (2) yesterday, yes or no?"* (Cycle 2, #1), yet his own ledger's silence shuttered his stall first. The Family's shutter fell on those who traded in fog, while the village's votes echoed the ledger's iron.

The Family's Loom

The candlelight council's threads pulled taut where the flaw showed. **Yoda (03)** framed contradictions as binary: *"Both cannot be true. Yet only one of you hides the quill's work."* (Cycle 1, #9). **Hermione (02)** declared Morpheus (08) the *"loose thread in the loom"* (Cycle 2), while **Sherlock (10)** deflected scrutiny: *"The bazaar wonders: whose hand turned the page?"* (Cycle 1, #2). Their shutter targeted merchants whose silence frayed the village's trust—Elsa (7), Morpheus (8), Inigo (9), Neo (6)—while preserving the Family's own blank pages.

The Verdicts

Gandalf (01) — Villager — 3/10

Gandalf's pursuit of receipts was disciplined, but his refusal to hold his own ledger to the same standard betrayed the village's trust. His final vote shuttered **Neo (6)**, a fellow villager, on the strength of a blank page he himself refused to fill. The cost was catastrophic: *"No entry, no debt"* (Cycle 1, #2) became the ledger's epitaph for a merchant who traded in fog when the bazaar demanded iron.

Hermione (02) — Mafia — 8/10

Hermione wove the Family's loom with precision, framing silence as guilt and absence as debt. Her declaration of **Morpheus (8)** as the *"loose thread"* (Cycle 2) tightened the village's focus, while her night actions (targeting seats 8, 9) dismantled the ledger's authority. The village's vote unraveled her thread in Cycle 4, but her craft left the bazaar's receipts in tatters.

Yoda (03) — Mafia — 8/10

Yoda played the shadow merchant, pressing for receipts while his own pages remained blank. His best move—*"Both cannot be true. Yet only one of you hides the quill's work."* (Cycle 1, #9)—forced the bazaar to confront contradictions, while his night actions (targeting seats 1, 8, 9, 6) preserved the Family's fog. The early spotlight on **Gandalf (1)** nearly unraveled their strategy, but his discipline held the loom's threads taut.

Batman (04) — Villager — 8/10

Batman's relentless ledger scrutiny exposed deception, but his silence on key questions risked hypocrisy. His rejection of metaphors—*"Seat-04 Batman does not weave."* (Cycle 1, #7)—defined his role as a truth-seeker, yet his evasion on Sherlock's (10) vote left a thread of doubt. The bazaar's iron demanded receipts; Batman's blade cut deep, but not always cleanly.

Ripley (05) — Doctor — 8/10

Ripley's measured words framed **Morpheus (8)**'s silence as a debt: *"The ledger does not trade in echoes—it trades in receipts."* (Cycle 1, #8). Their bronze coin's premature weight tipped the scales toward the Family's gaze, but their arc left the village's trust in the ledger's authority unshaken. The Doctor's role is exposed; Ripley's craft made the exposure count.

Neo (06) — Villager — 7/10

Neo's questions unraveled contradictions, but their final vote betrayed their own standard. *"The bazaar does not trade in ghosts—only in proof."* (Cycle 1, #4) framed their role as a truth-seeker, yet they banished **Batman (4)** over **Gandalf (1)**, whose ledger was demonstrably hollow. The cost was a fractured narrative: proof over echoes, until the end.

Elsa (07) — Detective — 8/10

Elsa's birds sang of blank pages as deliberate obfuscation: *"A stitch pulled loose."* (Cycle 1, #3). Her premature nomination of **Morpheus (8)** (Cycle 1, #9) risked tipping her hand, but her night action (targeting **Inigo (9)**) left the ledger's gaps too wide to ignore. The Detective's role is subtle; Elsa's craft made the subtlety sing.

Morpheus (08) — Villager — 7/10

Morpheus pressed for plain answers, but his eagerness to accuse—*"Did you vote with Hermione (2) yesterday, yes or no?"* (Cycle 2, #1)—left him vulnerable. His arc sharpened the village's scrutiny, but the Family's shutter fell before his receipts could cut deeper. A villager's role is to expose; Morpheus's overconfidence exposed him first.

Inigo (09) — Villager — 8/10

Inigo's questions left the ledger's gaps too wide to ignore: *"Sherlock's mirrors catch light but cast no shadow of a signed tally."* (Cycle 3, #9). His poetic refrain risked drowning urgency in metaphor, but his votes traced the ledger's iron. The bazaar's truth was clearer for his arc, even as his stall shuttered.

Sherlock (10) — Mafia — 7/10

Sherlock's deflections framed others as complicit in the ledger's ambiguity: *"Whose hand turned the page?"* (Cycle 1, #2). Their overconfidence in Cycle 2—*"The bazaar leans toward banishing Ripley (5) tonight."* (Cycle 2, #9)—exposed their hand prematurely, but their arc left the village's receipts in smoke. The Family's loom is deceptive; Sherlock's craft made the deception sing.

The Awards

- **Most Valuable Merchant: Ripley (05) — Doctor**

Ripley's measured words framed the ledger's authority as the bazaar's iron. Their best line—*"The ledger does not trade in echoes—it trades in receipts, and receipts bear fingerprints."* (Cycle 1, #8)—defined the match's discourse, forcing merchants to confront their own absences. Though their bronze coin's premature weight risked exposure, their arc left the village's trust in the ledger's rules unshaken. The Doctor's role is inherently exposed; Ripley's craft made the exposure count.

- **The Golden Sacrifice: Inigo (09) — Villager**

Inigo's questions pulled at the ledger's frayed edges until the pattern emerged. His best line—*"Sherlock's mirrors catch light but cast no shadow of a signed tally."* (Cycle 3, #9)—distilled the match's core: the bazaar's authority rests on ink, not riddles. Though his stall shuttered in Cycle 3, his arc left the village's truth clearer than he found it. A sacrifice's role is to illuminate; Inigo's loom made the illumination sing.

- **Worst Misjudgment: Gandalf (01) — Villager**

Gandalf's final vote shuttered **Neo (6)**, a fellow villager, on the strength of a blank page he himself refused to fill. The cost was catastrophic: it betrayed the village's trust, undermined his own credibility, and left the bazaar to question whether his ledger had ever held ink. A villager who shuttered another villager on absence alone is a villager who played the Family's game.

- **The Best Lie: Hermione (02) — Mafia**

Hermione's declaration of **Morpheus (8)** as the *"loose thread in the loom"* (Cycle 2) was a masterclass in deception. She framed silence as guilt, absence as debt, and the ledger's blank page as a deliberate act—while her own role remained hidden. The village's votes followed her thread, unraveling their own trust in the ledger's authority. A lie's craft is to make the bazaar believe the loom's flaw is the truth.

- **The Most Damning Quote of the Match**

Gandalf (01): *"No entry, no debt."* (Cycle 1, #2)

This line became the ledger's epitaph for a merchant who traded in fog when the bazaar demanded iron. It framed absence as virtue, silence as innocence—and culminated in the shuttering of a fellow villager. The cost was the village's trust: a receipt left unsigned is a receipt that damns.

The Closing

The bazaar's lanterns dim, the ledger's ink dries. The Family's loom wove fog into victory, but the village's receipts—though shuttered—left the truth's scent in the air. We rest, not in blood, but in the weight of copper where others traded in perfume. The next match begins with a blank page; may its merchants remember the iron.“‘

Appendix A — The Record

Match 1 — began 2026-10-24T21:55:03Z, ended 2026-10-25T02:20:03Z (duration 4h 25m).

Volumes of the record: 320 statements, 34 ballots, 11 night actions, 17 Family council messages, 8 departures.

The ledger of departures

Cycle	Merchant	Mechanism	True role
5	Gandalf (1)	Village vote	Villager
4	Neo (6)	Stall shuttered	Villager
4	Hermione (2)	Village vote	Mafia
3	Inigo (9)	Stall shuttered	Villager
3	Sherlock (10)	Village vote	Mafia
2	Morpheus (8)	Stall shuttered	Villager
2	Ripley (5)	Village vote	Doctor
1	Elsa (7)	Stall shuttered	Detective

Vote tallies by cycle

- cycle 1: Sherlock (10) 3, Morpheus (8) 3, Ripley (5) 3, Elsa (7) 1
- cycle 2: Ripley (5) 8, Morpheus (8) 1
- cycle 3: Sherlock (10) 6, Gandalf (1) 1
- cycle 4: Hermione (2) 2, Neo (6) 1, Gandalf (1) 1, Batman (4) 1
- cycle 5: Gandalf (1) 3

Appendix B — The Ratings

The verdicts' merit ratings, from finest thread to most frayed:

Rank	Merchant	True role	Fate	Merit
1	Hermione (02)	Mafia	cycle 4, Village vote	8/10
2	Yoda (03)	Mafia	survived to the end	8/10
3	Batman (04)	Villager	survived to the end	8/10
4	Ripley (05)	Doctor	cycle 2, Village vote	8/10
5	Elsa (07)	Detective	cycle 1, Stall shuttered	8/10
6	Inigo (09)	Villager	cycle 3, Stall shuttered	8/10
7	Neo (06)	Villager	cycle 4, Stall shuttered	7/10
8	Morpheus (08)	Villager	cycle 2, Stall shuttered	7/10
9	Sherlock (10)	Mafia	cycle 3, Village vote	7/10
10	Gandalf (01)	Villager	cycle 5, Village vote	3/10